When the vowel which caused umlaut was **u**, it is called **u**-umlaut, and when **ŏ**, or **a**, it is called **o/a**-umlaut.

u- and **o/a**-umlaut of **a** only took place in Mercian, as **featu**, *vats*, **heafuc**, *hawk*, **steapul**, *pillar*, **steaþul**, *foundation*, beside **fatu**, **hafoc**, **stapol**, **staþol** in the other dialects. **fearan**, *to go*, **fearaþ**, *they go*, **feata**, *of vats*, beside **faran**, **faraþ**, **fata** in the other dialects. See § **78**.

u-umlaut of **e** and **i**, and **o/a**-umlaut of **i** took place in Ken. before all single consonants, in Anglian before all single consonants except gutturals (**c**, **g**), but in WS. only before labials and liquids, as **eofor** (OHG. **ebur**), *boar*; **heolostor** from older **helustr**, *hiding place*; **heorut**, *hart*. **meodu**, *mead* (*drink*), **eosol**, *donkey* = WS. **medu**, **esol**. Ken. **breogo**, *prince* = WS. and Anglian **brego**, see § **92**. **mioluc**, *milk*; **cliopung**, *calling*. **siodu**, *custom*, **sionu**, *sinew* = WS. **sidu**, **sinu**. Ken. **siocol**, *sickle*, **stiogol**, *stile* = WS. and Anglian **sicol**, **stigol**, see § **101**. **liofast**, *thou livest*. **nioma(n)**, *to take*, **niomaþ**, *they take*, **wiotan**, *to know* = WS. **niman**, **nimaþ**, **witan**. Ken. **stiocian** from ***stikōjan**, *to prick* = WS. and Anglian **stician**, see §§ **92–3**, **102**.

o/a-umlaut of **e** did not take place in WS. In Ken. it took place before all single consonants and in Anglian before all single consonants except gutturals, as **beoran**, *to bear*, **eotan**, *to eat*, **feola**, *many* = WS. **beran**, **etan**, **fela**. Ken. **weogas**, *ways*, **spreocan**, *to speak* = WS. and Anglian **wegas**, **spreca(n)**, see § **93**.

2. Breaking.

§ **49**. Breaking is due to the influence of an **l**, **r**, or **h** + consonant, or single **h**, upon a preceding vowel (Germanic **a**, **e**, **i**; **ǣ**, **ī**) whereby a guttural glide was developed between the vowel and the consonant, which then combined with the vowel to form a diphthong. For the reason why breaking took place before **l** and **r** + consonant more regu-

larly in WS. and Ken. than in Anglian, see § 7. In the examples given below we shall confine ourselves chiefly to WS.

a (**æ**) > **ea**, as **ceald**, Goth. **kalds**, *cold*; **healdan**, Goth. **haldan**, *to hold* (§ 64); **bearn**, Goth. **barn**, *child*; **heard**, Goth. **hardus**, *hard* (§ 66); **eahta**, Goth. **ahtáu**, *eight*; **weaxan**, Goth. **wahsjan**, *to grow*; **seah**, OHG. **sah**, *he saw* (§ 68).

e > **eo**, as **meolcan**, OHG. **melkan**, *to milk*; **sceolh**, OHG. **scelh**, *wry, oblique* (§ 84); **eorþe**, OHG. **erda**, *earth*; **heorte**, OHG. **herza**, *heart* (§ 85); **cneoht**, OHG. **kneht**, *boy*; **seox**, OHG. **sehs**, *six*; **seoh**, *see thou* (§ 86).

i > **io** (later **eo**), as **liornian, leornian**, from ***lirnōjan**, *to learn*; **miox, meox**, from ***mihst**, *manure* (§ 98).

ǣ > **ēa** in WS. before **h**, as **nēah**, Goth. **nēhv**, *near*; **nēar** from ***nēahur**, older ***nǣhur** (§ 123).

ī > **īo** (later **ēo**) in WS. before **h** and **ht**, as **lēoht**, Goth. **leihts**, adj. *light*; **wēoh**, *idol*, Goth. **weihs**, *holy* (§ 127).

3. Influence of Nasals.

§ 50. **a** became a low-back-wide vowel, written **a, o**, before nasals, as **camb, comb**, *comb*; **nama, noma**, *name*; **land, lond**, *land*; **lang, long**, *long* (§ 59).

e > **i** before Germanic **m** (§ 81), and in early Latin loan-words before nasal + consonant (§ 82), as **niman**, OHG. **neman**, *to take*; **gimm**, Lat. **gemma**, *gem*; **pinsian**, Lat. **pensāre**, *to weigh, ponder, consider*.

o > **u** before nasals, as **guma**, OHG. **gomo**, *man*; **numen**, OHG. **ginoman**, *taken*; **hunig**, OHG. **honag**, *honey*; **þunor**, OHG. **donar**, *thunder* (§ 109).

ǣ > **ō** before nasals (§ 121), as **mōna**, Goth. **mēna**, *moon*; **nōmon**, Goth. **nēmun**, *they took*.

Nasals disappeared before the voiceless spirants **f, þ**, and **s** with lengthening of the preceding vowel, as **fīf**,

OHG. **fimf**, *five*; **ōsle**, OHG. **amsala**, *ousel* (§ **283**); **cūþ**, Goth. **kunþs**, *known*; **gōs**, OHG. **gans**, *goose*; **ōþer**, Goth. **anþar**, *other* (§ **286**).

4. Influence of Initial Palatal Consonants.

§ **51.** Between palatal **c** (§ **309**), **g** (= Germanic **ʒ**, § **313**), **g** (= Germanic **j**, § **268**), **sc** (§ **312**), and the following palatal vowel, a glide was developed in prim. OE., which combined with the vowel to form a rising diphthong, and then at a later period the rising diphthong became a falling diphthong through the shifting of the stress from the second to the first element of the diphthong. The examples given below are chiefly WS.; for the corresponding forms in the other dialects, the student should consult the paragraphs within brackets.

æ > **ea** (older **eǽ**), as **ceaster**, Lat. **castra**, *city, fortress*; **ceaf**, *chaff*; **geaf**, Goth. **gaf**, *he gave*; **sceaft**, OHG. **scaft**, *shaft*; **sceal**, Goth. **skal**, *shall* (§ **72**).

e > **ie** (older **ié**), as **cieres**, Lat. **cerasum**, *cherry-tree*; **giefan**, OHG. **geban**, *to give*; **scieran**, OHG. **sceran**, *to shear* (§ **91**). **ciele** from ***keli**, older ***kaliz**, *cold*; **giest** from ***ʒest**, older ***ʒastiz**, *guest*; **scieppan** from ***skeppan**, Goth. **skapjan**, *to create* (§ **73**).

ǣ > **ēa** (older **eǽ**), as **cēace**, prim. Germanic ***kǣkōn-**, *jaw*; **gēafon**, Goth. **gēbun**, *they gave*; **gēar**, Goth. **jēr**, *year*; **scēap**, Goth. ***skēp**, *sheep* (§ **124**).

Note.—In forms like **gioc**, **geoc** (OHG. **joh**), *yoke* (§ **110**); **giong**, **geong** (OHG. **jung**), *young* (§ **116**); **geōmor** (OHG. **jāmar**), *sad* (§ **122**, Note), the **io**, **eo**, **eō** may have been rising diphthongs, but it is difficult to determine how far they were diphthongs at all, and how far the **i**, **e** were merely inserted to indicate the palatal nature of the **g** = Germanic **j** (§ **268**). It is highly probable that in forms like **sceacan**, *to shake*, **sceadu**, *shadow*, beside **scacan**, **scadu** (§ **57**, Note), **sceolde**, OHG. **scolta**, *should* (§ **110**), **sceādan** beside **scādan**, *to divide*

(§ **133**, Note 2), the **e** was merely inserted to indicate the palatal nature of the **sc** (§ **312**).

5. Influence of w.

§ **52.** **e** and **ē** (= Germanic **ǣ**) were often rounded to **œ** and **œ̄** after **w** in Nth., as **cuœþa**, WS. **cweþan**, *to say* (§ **80**, Note 1); **cuœlla**, WS. **cwellan**, *to kill*; **tuœlf**, WS. **twelf**, *twelve* (§ **55**, Note 1). **huœ̄r**, *where*, **wœ̄ron**, *were* = WS. **hwǣr**, **wǣron** (§ **119**, Note 2).

e became **eo** before **w** + a following vowel, as gen. **cneowes**, **treowes**, beside nom. **cnēo**, *knee*, **trēo**, *tree* (§ **89**); **eowestre** (cp. Goth. **awistr**), *sheepfold*; **meowle** (Goth. **mawilō**), *maiden* (§ **77**).

ǣ became **ā** before **w**, as **blāwan** from ***blǣwan**, *to blow*; **cnāwan**, *to know*; **sāwon**, *they saw* (§ **120**).

Initial **weo-** became **wu-** (rarely **wo-**) in late WS, as **swurd**, *sword*, **swuster**, *sister*, **worold**, **woruld**, *world*, beside older **sweord** (OHG. **swert**), **sweostor** (OHG. **swester**), **weorold** (OHG. **weralt**), see § **94**.

Initial **wio-** became **wu-** in WS. and Anglian, but remained in Ken., as **wudu**, *wood*, beside Ken. **wiodu** (§ **103**).

§ **53.** The following was the chronological order in which the sound-laws stated in §§ **47–52** took place: (1) The influence of nasals. (2) Breaking. (3) The influence of initial palatal consonants. (4) **i**-umlaut. (5) **u-**, **o/a-** umlaut. (6) Influence of **w**.

Note.—In the case of words where diphthongization by preceding palatals and **u-**, **o/a**-umlaut concur, the latter has the predominance, as **geolo**, *yellow*; **geoloca**, *yolk*; **ceole** (acc. **ceolan**, § **403**), *throat*. This does not however prove that **u**, **o/a**-umlaut chronologically precedes diphthongization by preceding palatals. Either **geolo**, &c., are not pure WS. forms (see § **92**) or else the **ie** became **eo** by umlaut, in which case forms like **giefu** (§ **365**) would have **ie** from the oblique cases.

A. The Short Vowels of Accented Syllables.

a

§ **54.** Apart from the influence of neighbouring sounds the normal development of Germanic **a** (= Goth. O.Icel. OS. OHG. **a**) is **æ** in OE.

Examples in closed syllables are: **dæg**, Goth. **dags**, O.Icel. **dagr**, OS. **dag**, OHG. **tag**, *day*; **þæt**, Goth. **þata**, O.Icel. **þat**, OS. **that**, OHG. **daz**, *the*; and similarly **bæc**, *back*; **bæþ**, *bath*; **blæc**, *black*; **bræs**, *brass*; **cræft**, *skill*; **dæl**, *dale*; **æfter**, *after*; **æt** (unstressed **ot**), *at*; **fæst**, *fast, firm*; **fæt**, *vat, vessel*; **glæd**, *glad*; **glæs**, *glass*; **græs** (**gærs**), *grass*; **hæfde**, *he had*; **hwæl**, *whale*; **hwæt**, *what*; **pæþ**, *path*; **sægde**, *he said*; **smæl**, *small*; **stæf**, *staff*; in the pret. sing. of strong verbs belonging to classes IV (§ **503**) and V (§ **505**), as **bær** (Goth. O.Icel. OS. OHG. **bar**), *bore*; **bræc**, *broke*; **cwæþ**, *said*; **sæt**, *sat*; **wæs**, *was*. On forms like **æppel**, *apple*, beside pl. **appla**, see § **57**.

Examples in open syllables when followed by a palatal vowel, or a vocalic nasal or liquid in the next syllable, are: **æcer** (Goth. **akrs**), *field, acre*; **æcern**, *acorn*; **fæder**, *father*; **fæger** (Goth. **fagrs**), *fair, beautiful*; **hlædel**, *ladle*; **hræfen**, **hræfn**, *raven*; **hwæþer**, *whether*; **mægen** (Goth. ***magn**), *power*; **nægel**, **nægl** (Goth. ***nagls**), *nail*; **wæter**, *water*; **fæþm** (Goth. ***faþms**), *embrace, fathom*; **hægl**, *hail*; **snægl**, *snail*; **tægl**, *tail*; **wægn**, *wagon*; sing. gen. **dæges**, **fætes**, dat. **dæge**, **fæte**, beside nom. **dæg**, *day*; **fæt**, *vat*.

Note.—1. **æ** became **e** in Ken. and partly also in Mercian, as **deg**, **feder**, **fet**, **hefde**, **set**, **wes**, **weter** = WS. **dæg**, **fæder**, &c.

2. **æ** became **ǣ** by loss of **g**, as **brǣd**, *he brandished*; **mǣden**, *maiden*; **sǣde**, *he said*; **wǣn**, *wagon*, beside **brægd**, **mægden** (§ 58), **sægde**, **wægn**.

3. **a** often occurs where we should expect **æ**. In such cases the **a** is due to levelling and new formations, as sing. gen. **paþes**,